



FATIMA KHADIJAH'S THE POLITICS OF *play*

**A FIELD GUIDE FOR
REMAINING BEAUTIFULLY
DIFFICULT TO DOMINATE.**

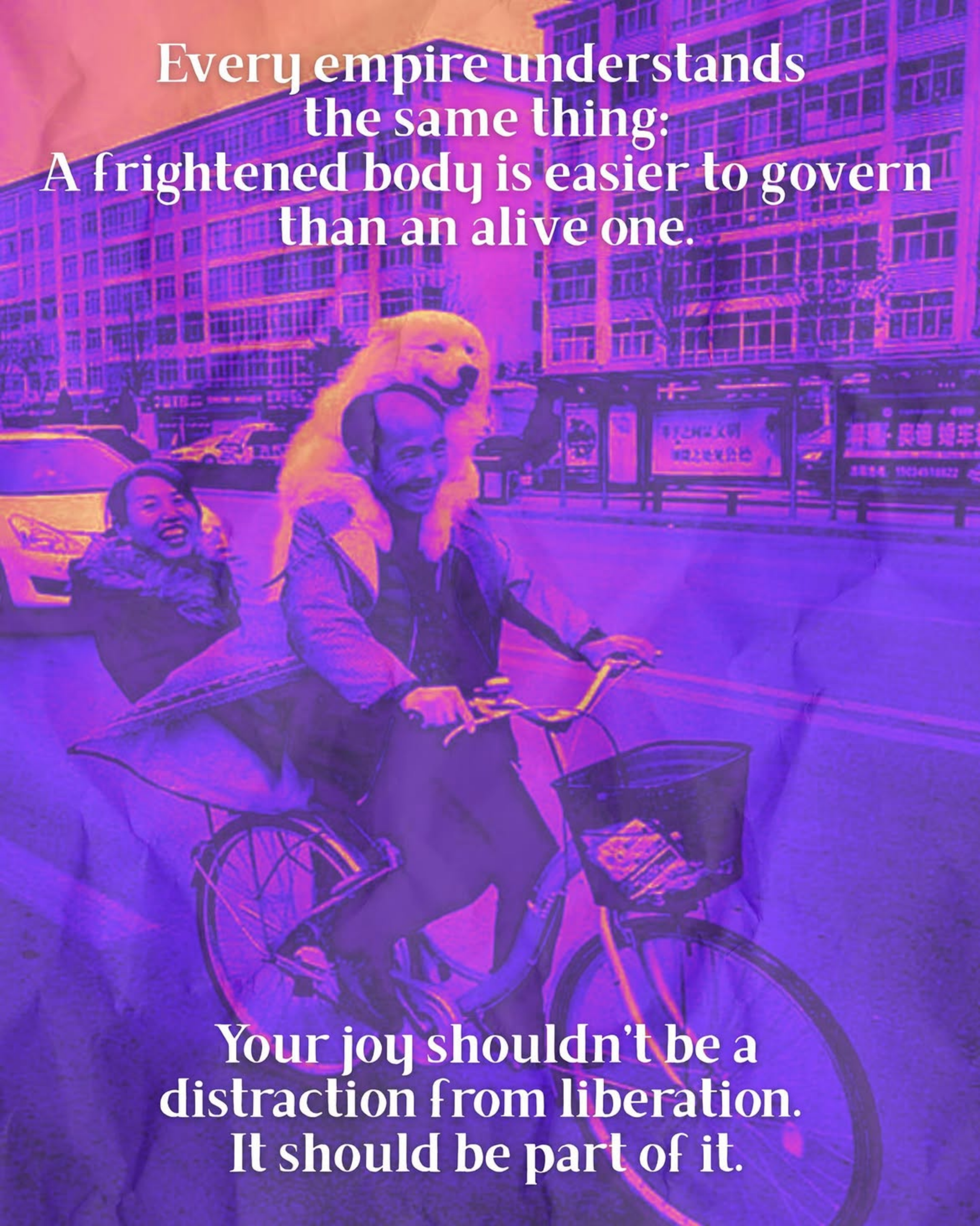
**To practice foolery is a refusal...
A refusal to let authoritarianism
colonize your nervous system.**

**Play is not only a form
of resistance but it
makes life worth living
while resisting.**



Every empire understands
the same thing:
A frightened body is easier to govern
than an alive one.

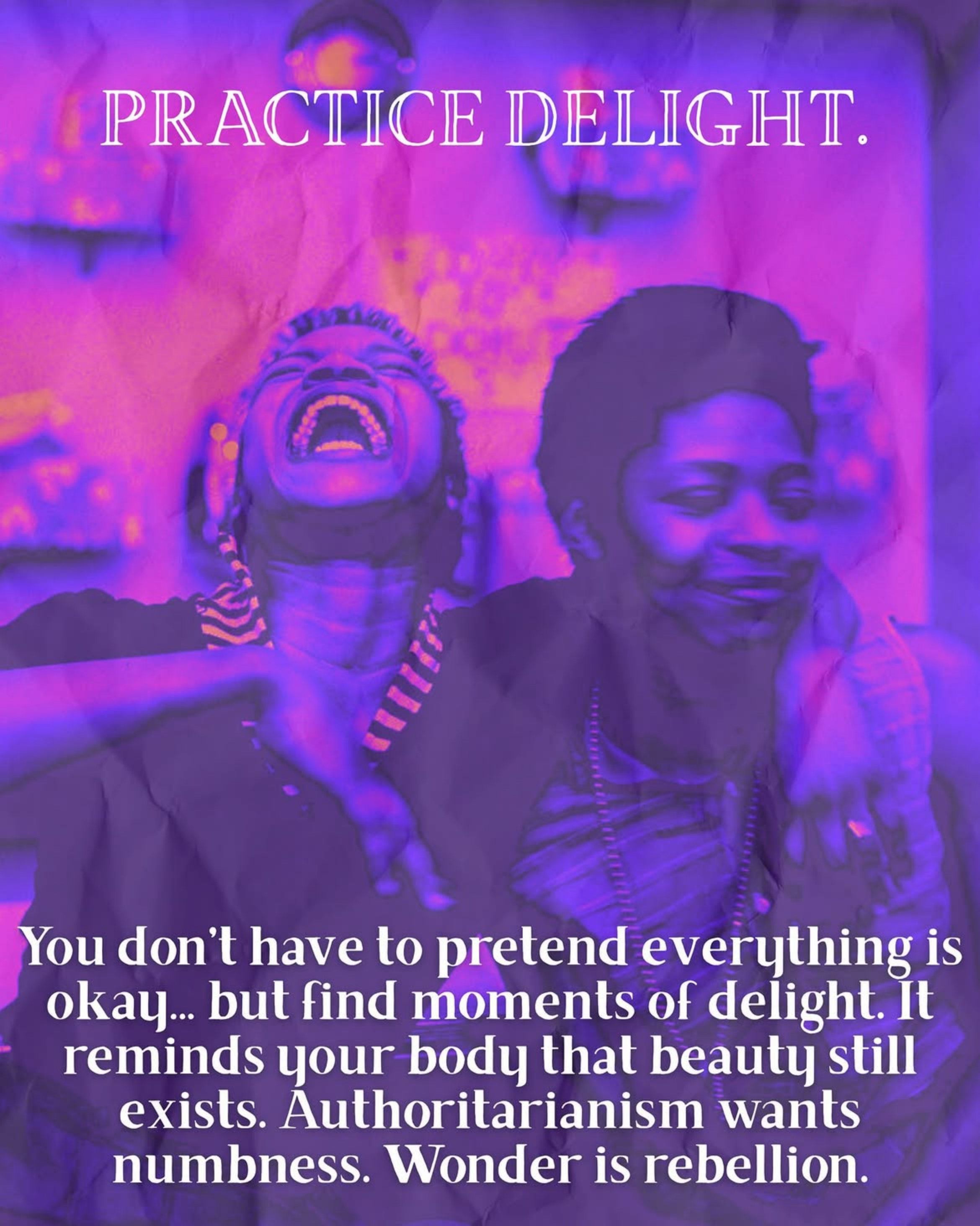
Your joy shouldn't be a
distraction from liberation.
It should be part of it.



PRACTICE ATTENTION.



Notice the birds. The weeds breaking through concrete. The way sunlight changes a room. Notice wayyyy more than Peter Theil wants you to. Wake up to your own life.



PRACTICE DELIGHT.

You don't have to pretend everything is okay... but find moments of delight. It reminds your body that beauty still exists. Authoritarianism wants numbness. Wonder is rebellion.

A photograph of two women dancing in a room with warm, golden light. The woman on the left is wearing a dark, sleeveless top and a long, dark skirt. She has her hair styled in a bun and is smiling. The woman on the right is wearing a patterned top and a long, patterned skirt. She has her hair styled in a bun and is also smiling. They are both holding hands and appear to be in the middle of a dance. The background is slightly blurred, showing other people and furniture, suggesting a social gathering or a community event.

PRACTICE REPAIR.

Apologize. Mend the shirt. Water
the dying plant. Call the friend.
Commons are built less by
perfectionism than by repair.

A photograph of a man in a hat and plaid shirt playing an acoustic guitar on a city street. In the foreground, a woman in a white dress is dancing with her arms outstretched. The background shows other pedestrians and city buildings.

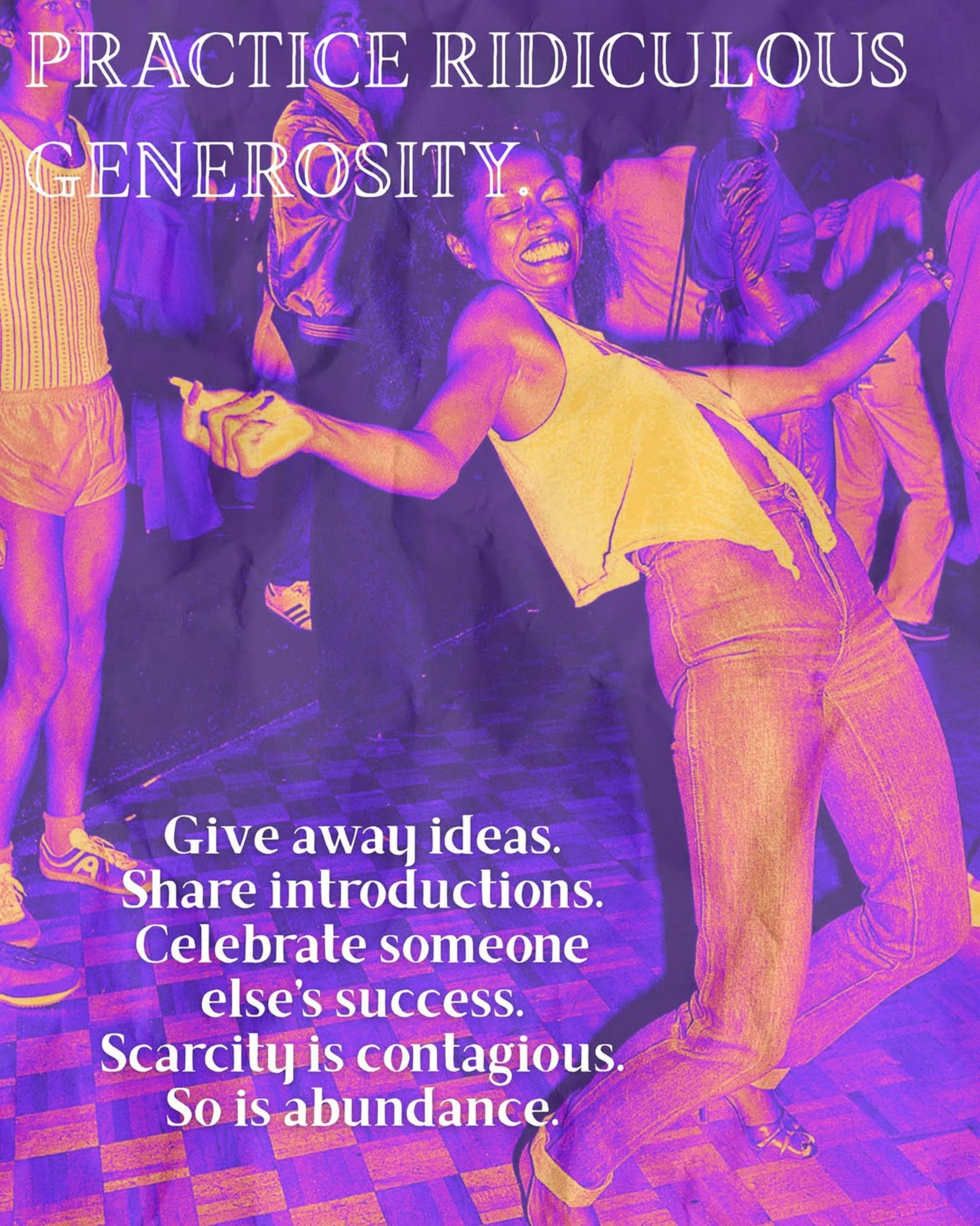
PRACTICE
ASKING
STRANGERS
QUESTIONS.

Curiosity dissolves caricatures.
Every genuine conversation is a
small act of democracy.

A woman in a red dress is dancing in a museum gallery. In the background, a bronze statue of a ballerina stands on a pedestal. The room has white walls, track lighting, and several framed artworks. The text "PRACTICE MAKING GIFTS." is overlaid in white serif font on the right side of the image.

PRACTICE
MAKING
GIFTS.

Not everything
beautiful needs a price tag.
Bake bread. Write letters.
Leave anonymous flowers.
Create more than you
consume.



PRACTICE RIDICULOUS GENEROSITY.

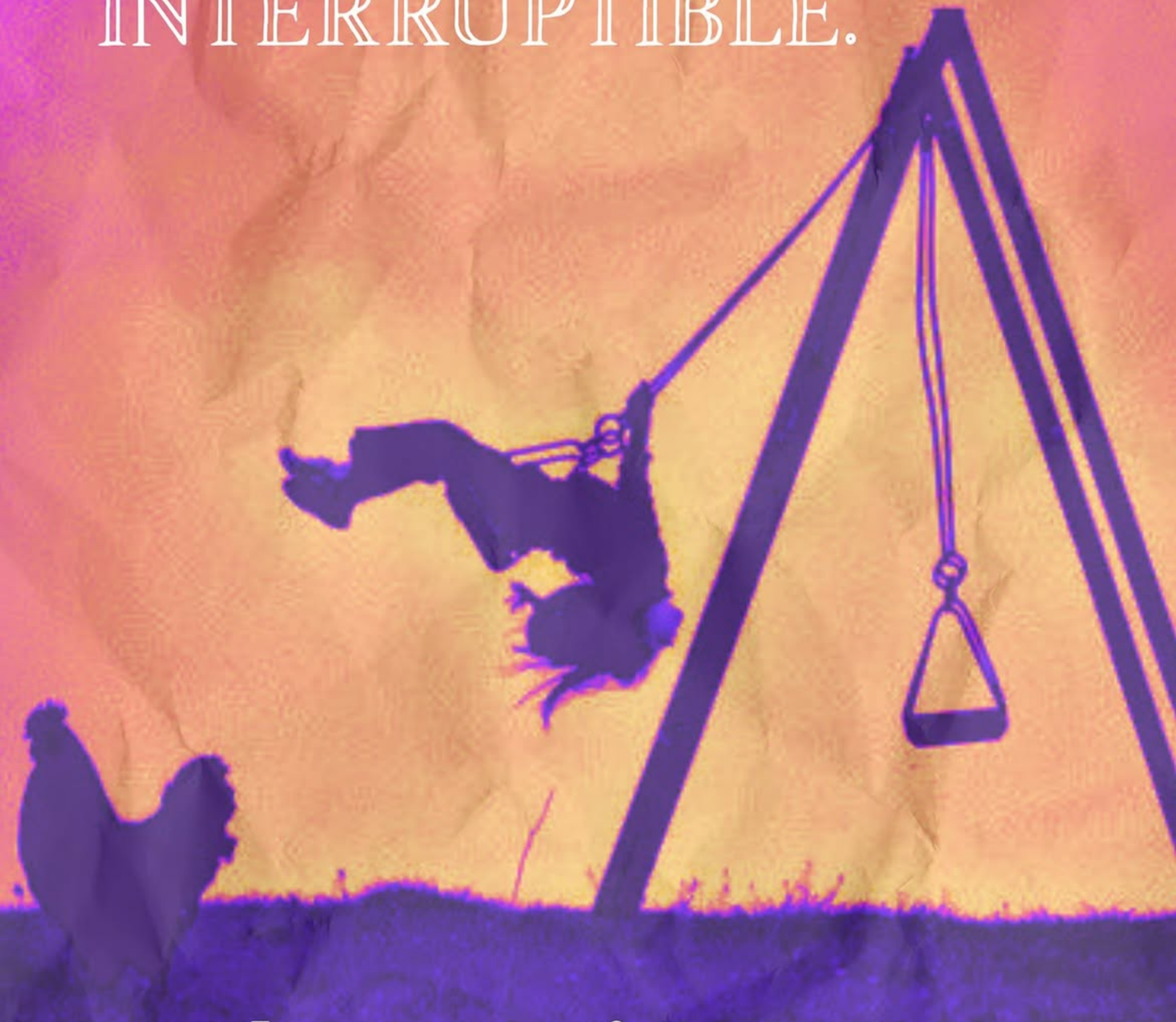
Give away ideas.
Share introductions.
Celebrate someone
else's success.
Scarcity is contagious.
So is abundance.

A woman in a black dress is captured in a dynamic, mid-motion dance pose in a library. She is leaning forward with one leg extended back. The background is filled with bookshelves, a skull on a shelf, and a framed portrait. The lighting is dramatic, with strong highlights and deep shadows.

PRACTICE DANCING BADLY.

Perfection is surveillance turned
inward. Dance anyway. Bodies
remember freedom before minds do.

PRACTICE BEING
INTERRUPTIBLE.

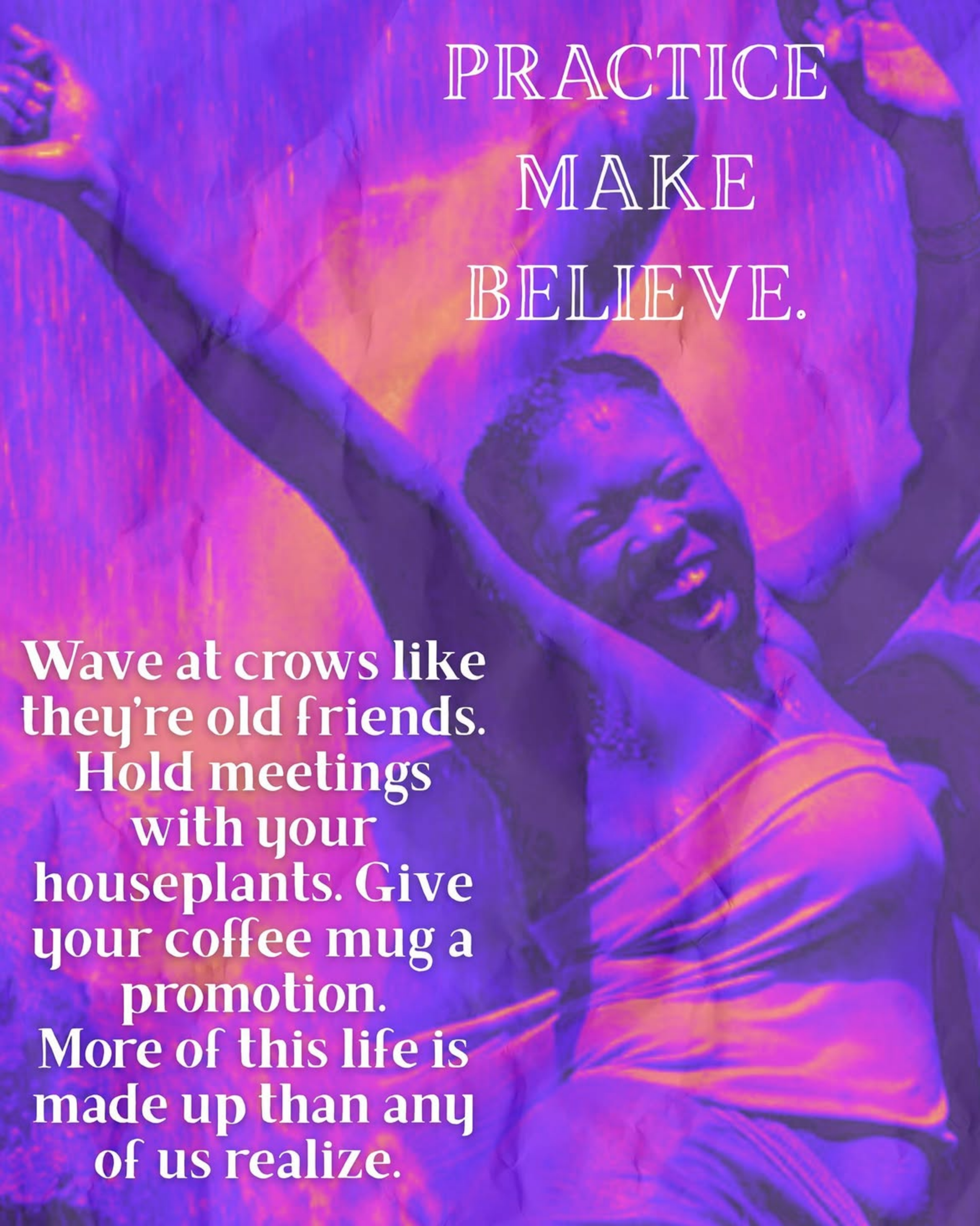


Leave room for surprise.
Some of life's greatest teachers
never made an appointment.

A photograph of four children standing on a city street at night. From left to right: a boy in a plaid shirt plays an acoustic guitar and sings; a girl in a blue shirt and patterned skirt plays a flute; a boy in a plaid shirt and suspenders plays a xylophone; and a boy in a blue shirt and suspenders plays a trumpet. In the background, a black car is parked on the street, and a person is walking away. The scene is lit by streetlights, creating a warm, orange glow.

PRACTICE COLLECTIVE COURAGE.

**Find your people. Cook together.
Grieve together. Laugh together.
No one survives history alone.**

A man in a blue shirt is shown from the chest up, with his arms raised high in the air. He is smiling and looking towards the camera. The background is a blurred crowd of people, suggesting a large gathering or event. The overall image has a warm, golden-brown color cast.

PRACTICE MAKE BELIEVE.

**Wave at crows like
they're old friends.
Hold meetings
with your
houseplants. Give
your coffee mug a
promotion.
More of this life is
made up than any
of us realize.**



PRACTICE BEAUTIFUL MISCHIEF.

Hide a tiny note in a library book.
Leave googly eyes somewhere they'll
make someone laugh. Mail a postcard to
a friend for no reason. Become evidence
that the world is still capable of
surprising people.

PRACTICE BECOMING.

Become harder to predict.

Easier to delight.

Quicker to forgive.

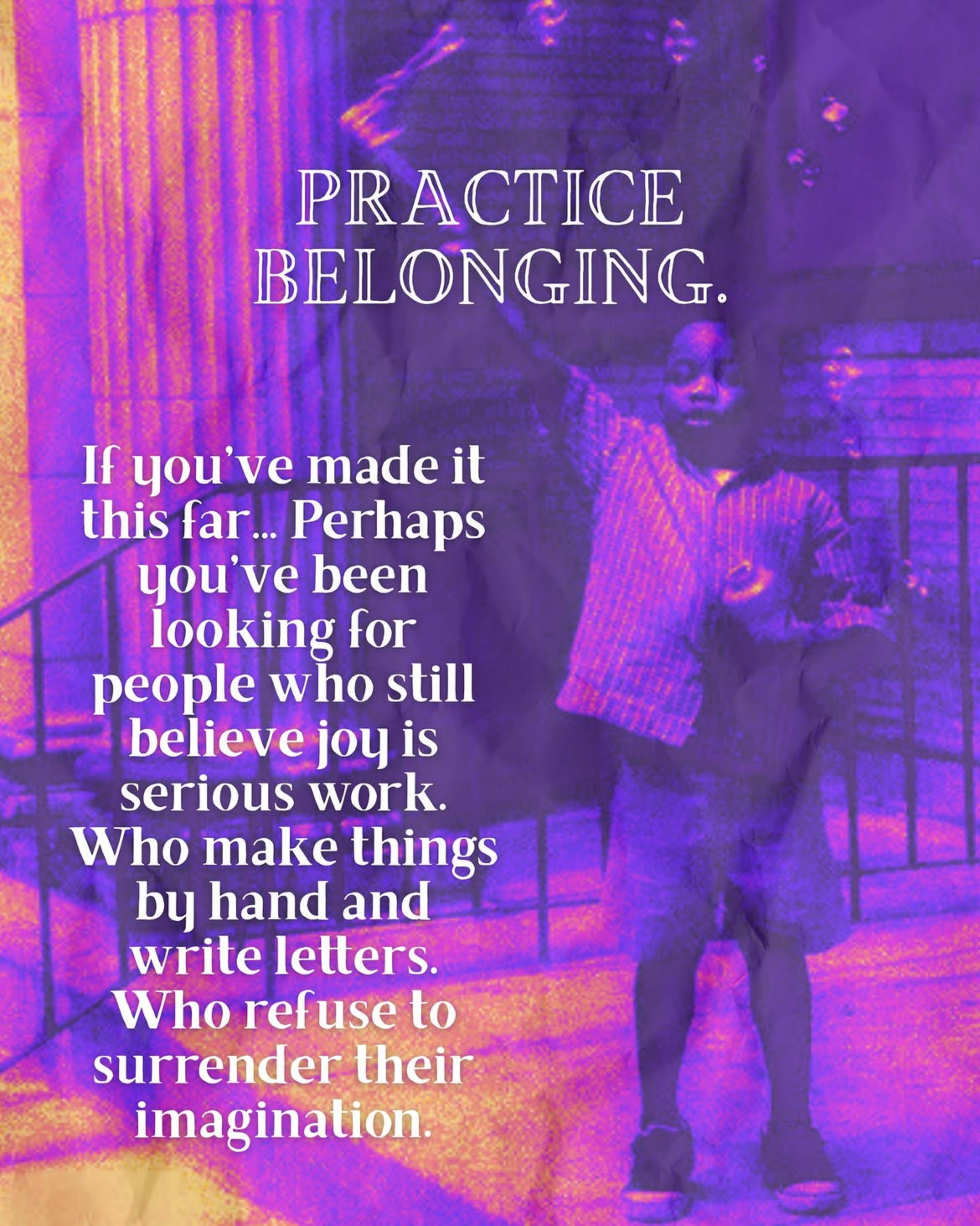
Slower to despair.

More impossible to own.

That, perhaps, is the most
political thing you can do.

The image is a vertical composition. The background is a close-up of a brown horse's head, wearing a bridle with blinkers, looking slightly to the left. The foreground features a small, light-colored dog, possibly a Chihuahua, looking directly at the camera with a wide, happy smile. The dog has large, dark eyes and a black collar with a tag. The overall image has a warm, golden-yellow tint.

The politics of play is the opposite of an escape mechanism. It is about becoming the kind of people capable of creating a better world.

A woman with dark hair is dancing on a rooftop at night. She is wearing a red and white plaid shirt and black pants. Her right arm is raised, and she is holding a small object in her left hand. The background shows a brick wall and a metal railing. The lighting is warm, with a strong orange glow from the left.

PRACTICE BELONGING.

If you've made it
this far... Perhaps
you've been
looking for
people who still
believe joy is
serious work.
Who make things
by hand and
write letters.
Who refuse to
surrender their
imagination.